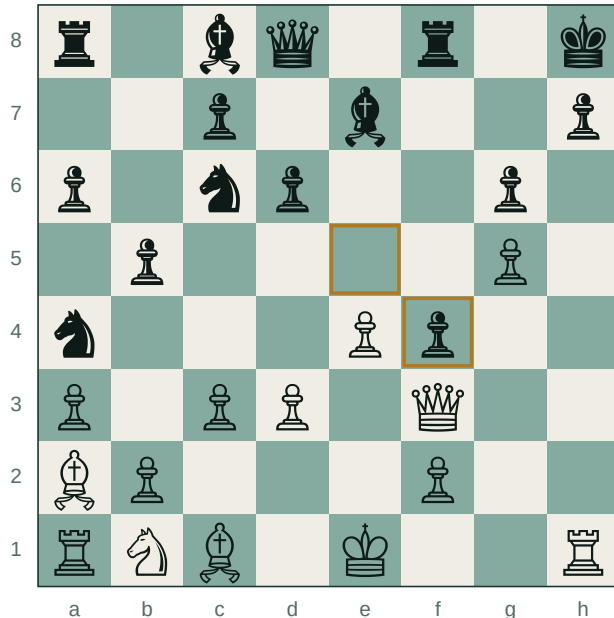


Attraction tactics: White, move 16

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 15...exf4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

16. Rxh7+ Kxh7 17. Qh1+ Bh3 18. Qxh3+ Kg7 19. Qh6#

16.Rxh7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From h7 it attacks king on h8 and bishop on e7. Recorded reply: **16...Kxh7**.

17.Qh1+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **17...Bh3**.

18.Qxh3+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the bishop on h3. Recorded reply: **18...Kg7**.

19.Qh6# Mate: queen on h6 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on h6. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h8. Absolute pin: pawn on h7.